Supreme Court. India and the United States should take hope from this encouraging rebirth of the liberal humanitarian rule of law emanating from Pakistan's capital, silenced for too many years by harsh repression.

India's elections in 2004 brought the Congress-led United Progressive Alliance back to power. Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, thanks to whose wisdom India's newly opened economy has enjoyed its miracle of globalized growth since 1991, affirmed his faith in and support of the cease-fire and the comprehensive peace process his predecessor had launched. India's traditional focus on higher education and its faith in science and the humanities has produced a vast pool of well-trained scientists and English-speaking graduates, tens of thousands of whom have over the past few decades been employed in newly built outsourcing centers of information in and around Bangalore and Mumbai, Chennai and New Delhi, linked round the clock to New York, Washington, Boston, and Los Angeles, providing assistance through cyberspace to millions of Americans in coping with their airline reservations, computers, new cars, and electronic machines that break down. The new Indo-U.S. Civil Nuclear Accord has added a strategic partnership to the burgeoning business union between the world's oldest and largest democracies. So while Pakistan sadly sank deeper into civil conflict, India and the United States forged a fresh alliance, sharing intelligence information as well as their most advanced scientific technology.

India's greatest potential internal weakness, however, lies in deep-rooted fears and prejudices against Muslims that many Hindu-first extremists continue to nurture, primarily in wealthy Gujarat, ironically the state in which Mahatma Gandhi was born. Orthodox Hindus believe that their divine king Raja Rama was born at Ayodhya in Uttar Pradesh (UP), at the very site of a Mughal mosque built in the sixteenth century to commemorate the conquest of northern India by Babur, founder of the Mughal Empire. Hindutva organizations led by the Vishwa Hindu Parishad (Universal Hindu Society) launched a national campaign to tear down Babur's mosque (Babri Masjid) and replace it with a reconstruction of "Rama's Birth-temple" *(Ram Janma-bhoomi)*, which they insisted had originally been erected on that very spot. The BJP joined the movement, leading a hundred thousand Hindus to Ayodhya in December 1992, where they used steel rods and brickbats to batter down the old mosque in nine hours of frenzied hammering and loud chanting of Lord Rama's name—"Ram, Ram, Hari!" Police watched unmoving as the mosque, which had withstood the rains of 460 monsoons, crumbled